

NUTRITIONAL RECOMMENDATIONS FOR HYPERLIPIDEMIA

- Hyperlipidemia, or dyslipidemia (an increase in the levels of cholesterol and lipids or fats in the blood), is a very common condition in our population and has harmful effects on health. It is associated with a greater likelihood of developing atherosclerosis and cardiovascular and cerebrovascular diseases.
- Hyperlipidemia is usually asymptomatic and may not be detected until the disease is already advanced and complications appear, such as acute myocardial infarction, stroke, or intermittent claudication.
- It is frequently associated with other cardiovascular risk factors such as high blood pressure, diabetes, or obesity.
- Although familial hyperlipidemias (of genetic origin) exist, most cases are associated with unhealthy dietary and lifestyle habits, including physical inactivity, high-fat diets, diets with excessive calorie intake, and smoking. Excessive intake of saturated fat and cholesterol is the main cause of hyperlipidemia.
- A healthy diet is essential for controlling hyperlipidemia. A Mediterranean diet supplemented with extra-virgin olive oil or nuts (walnuts, almonds, or hazelnuts) has been shown to reduce the incidence of serious cardiovascular events.
- Trans or hydrogenated fats (processed products) and the main sources of saturated fat and cholesterol should be avoided:
 - Animal fats: cream, bacon, pork fat, processed meats, etc.
 - Vegetable fats and oils: coconut, palm, cocoa butter, etc.
- The dietary guidance below is intended not only to reduce blood cholesterol and lipid levels, but also to improve cardiovascular risk and general health.

Nutritional guidance

WHAT SHOULD THE DIET BE LIKE?

The diet should be balanced, healthy, and varied. It should also provide an appropriate number of calories.

Recommended:

- Eat 2 or more servings of vegetables per day and 3 or more servings of fruit per day. Increase dietary fiber with raw and cooked vegetables, fresh fruit with the skin, legumes, and whole grains.
- Eat legumes (chickpeas, beans, lentils, peas, broad beans) 3-4 times per week.
- Eat nuts (walnuts, almonds, or hazelnuts) daily (30 g/day).
- Eat oily fish (sardines, salmon, tuna, etc.) 2-3 times per week. Seafood may be eaten in moderation.
- Use virgin olive oil for cooking instead of animal fats (lard, butter, margarine, tallow). For dressings, uncooked olive oil, virgin olive oil, sunflower oil, or corn oil may be used.

HOW TO PREPARE AND CHOOSE FOODS

- Use simple cooking methods that do not require much oil: griddle, steaming, grilling, baking, microwave, papillote, etc.
- Foods enriched with phytosterols may be consumed (up to a maximum of 2 g/day).

AVOID OR LIMIT

- It is advisable to control the consumption of animal fats:
 - Reduce intake of fatty meats (pork ribs, lamb ribs and fatty cuts in general, offal, processed meats, butifarra sausage).
 - Remove visible fat from meat and the skin from chicken. Meat may be marinated with spices or aromatic herbs.
 - Broths made from animal trimmings (bones, carcasses) should be defatted by removing all the fat that forms on the surface after the broth has cooled.
- Consume no more than 3-4 egg yolks per week. Egg whites may be consumed freely.
- Choose skimmed versions of all dairy products (milk, yogurt, and cheese).
- Avoid pastries and baked sweets, which are made with saturated fats:
 - Pastries and baked sweets in general: ensaimadas, croissants, churros, doughnuts, muffins, packaged cakes, and cakes.
 - Sliced bread and biscuits.
 - Cream-based ice cream.
- Pre-cooked dishes (cannelloni, lasagna, stews, pizzas), fatty snacks (potato chips, croquettes, empanadillas, snacks in general, fried fish), and dehydrated convenience foods (packet soups, spaghetti dishes, purees, and cream soups) are not recommended.
- Read the labels of all commercial products carefully to identify their ingredients. Products listing unspecified 'vegetable fats' probably contain coconut or palm fats, which are not recommended. A statement such as 'contains no cholesterol' does not necessarily mean the product is healthy, because it may still contain saturated fat.
- Limit alcohol consumption according to your doctor's recommendations.

OTHER RECOMMENDATIONS

- Maintaining an appropriate weight helps improve cholesterol levels.
- Be physically active according to your abilities: walking, swimming, cycling, aerobics, etc. Aerobic exercise is recommended for all healthy adults of any age. The recommended minimum is 150 minutes per week of moderate-intensity exercise (30 minutes a day, five days a week) or 75 minutes per week of vigorous exercise.
- Do not smoke tobacco or other herbal smoking products, because their use increases the prevalence of cardiovascular disease. Stopping smoking is the most effective measure for preventing cardiovascular disease.

RECOMMENDATIONS BY FOOD GROUP

FOOD GROUP	RECOMMENDED (every day)	LIMITED (maximum 2-3 times/week)	NOT RECOMMENDED (only exceptionally)
CEREALS	- Bread, pasta, rice, corn, etc., preferably whole-grain - Semolina, tapioca	- Refined cereals - Baked goods made with sunflower oil (muffins, sponge cake) - Sliced bread, rusks	Pastries and baked goods in general (croissants, ensaimadas, etc.) and snacks such as cheese puffs, pork rinds, etc.
VEGETABLES, LEGUMES, AND FRUIT	All	- Packaged potato chips prepared with olive or sunflower oil - Fruit in syrup	- Coconut - Packaged potato chips prepared with oils of unknown composition
EGGS	Egg whites	Whole eggs (up to 3-4 yolks per week)	
DAIRY PRODUCTS	- Skimmed milk and yogurt - Products made with skimmed milk - Cottage cheese - Fresh cheese or cheese with less than 20% fat (Burgos, light, fresh goat cheese, etc.)	- Semi-skimmed milk - Cheese with 20-30% fat (Edam, Brie, mozzarella, Parmesan, etc.)	- Whole milk - All other cheeses (more than 30% fat) - Cream and dairy cream - Flans, custards, creams, curd desserts, and milkshakes

RECOMMENDATIONS BY FOOD GROUP - CONTINUED

FOOD GROUP	RECOMMENDED (every day)	LIMITED (maximum 2-3 times/week)	NOT RECOMMENDED (only exceptionally)
FISH AND SEAFOOD	• White fish (sea bass, sole, monkfish, swordfish, gilt-head bream, hake, etc.) • Oily fish (sardines, anchovies, mackerel, salmon, tuna, etc.) • Canned fish	• Preserves packed in olive or sunflower oil • Seafood	• Commercial fried products or products fried in oils that are not recommended • Caviar and fish roe
MEAT AND POULTRY	• Chicken, turkey, and rabbit (without skin or fat)	• Lean cuts of veal, beef, horse, lamb, and pork • Ham (fat removed) • Lean hamburgers	• Veal, lamb, pork, duck, and goose • Processed meats, sausages, bacon, hamburgers, organ meats, and offal • Pates
FATS AND OILS	• Olive oil, preferably extra virgin • Seed oils (sunflower, corn)	• Margarines specifically labeled as free of trans fatty acids	• Butter, lard, pork fat, and tallow • Palm and coconut oils • Hydrogenated vegetable oils

RECOMMENDATIONS BY FOOD GROUP - CONTINUED

FOOD GROUP	RECOMMENDED (every day)	LIMITED (maximum 2-3 times/week)	NOT RECOMMENDED (only exceptionally)
SWEETS	• Pastries and desserts made with skimmed milk and oil, without egg yolk • Jam, honey, and sugar (in moderation)	• Pastries and desserts made with skimmed milk and oil, with egg yolk • Water ices, granitas, and sorbets • Nougat and marzipan	• Pastries and baked sweets in general • Desserts containing whole-milk dairy products and/or butter • Chocolate with less than 75% cocoa • Candy
NUTS	• Almonds, hazelnuts, and walnuts (preferably raw and unsalted)		
BEVERAGES	• Mineral water • Natural fruit juices • Coffee (maximum 3 per day), tea, and herbal infusions • Low-calorie ('light') soft drinks	• Packaged fruit juices	• Sugar-sweetened soft drinks • Distilled alcoholic beverages
SPICES AND SAUCES	• All spices • Sauces made with olive oil, vinegar, mustard, or aioli	• Mayonnaise made with egg	• Bechamel and sauces containing whole milk, butter, egg, and/or animal fats

SUMMARY

- The diet should be balanced, healthy, and varied.
- Increase consumption of legumes (at least 3-4 times per week), fruit (at least 3 pieces per day), and vegetables (2 servings per day).
- Eating nuts (walnuts, almonds, or hazelnuts) daily and oily fish 2-3 times per week is recommended.
- Avoid fatty meats, pastries and baked sweets, pre-cooked dishes, and dehydrated convenience foods.
- Increase intake of skimmed milk and other skimmed dairy products in place of full-fat dairy products.
- Consume no more than 2-3 egg yolks per week. Egg whites may be consumed freely.
- Maintaining an appropriate weight helps improve cholesterol levels.

FINAL RECOMMENDATION AND REFERENCES

- Be physically active according to your abilities.

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TRANSLATION NOTE

This document is an English translation of the supplied Spanish handout. It preserves the source's recommendations and references; it does not update or replace medical advice from a qualified clinician.